➢ The crushing strength should not be less than 55 kg/cm^2.

3.2.8 Hollow Blocks

Concrete blocks are now-a-days used for masonry construction. These blocks are available in three types namely solid blocks, hollow blocks and cellular blocks.

The normal concrete blocks are called as solid blocks.

If the percentage of voids is more than 25% then it is called as hollow blocks, if the percentage of voids is less than 25% it is called as perforated blocks.

Cellular blocks are generally referred as light weight aerated concerte blocks.





When was the first brick house built?

It was built in California in 1847.

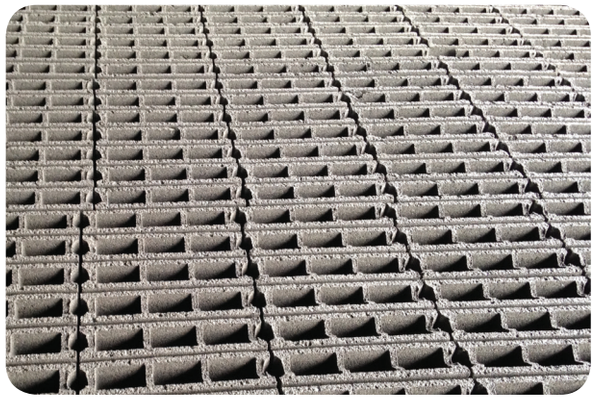
Search link: http://www.youtube.com> watch first brick house



ACTIVITY 4

Visit a brick manufacturing unit near by your school and prepare report with photos.

Concrete blocks are usually made large in size. So that the block work is faster and consume less cement in joints than the brick work. Specially made hollow blocks are also used to construct load bearing walls. Such works are useful in reducing the dead load of masonry in buildings.



3.2.8.1 Manufacturing of Hollow Blocks

The concrete mix for concrete blocks shall not be richer than one part of cement to six parts of volume of combined aggregate. Lean mixes upto 1:8 are also commonly used. The choice of aggregates for manufacturing these block is of utmost importance as cost of aggregates account for a large part of the total cost. Hence "Baby jelly" aggregates that are not generally used for conventional concrete work are found of much use in making these concrete blocks.

3.2.8.2 Classification of Hollow Blocks

Hollow concrete blocks are classified by IS into the following three grades.

A) **Grade A :** These blocks are used for load bearing walls. They should have a minimum density of 1500 kg/m^3. They should

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